



Make Your Own Media Centre

...in Under Rs 30,000

Sounds too good to be true? Read on to find out how to make your LCD/plasma TV so much more interesting that you'll forget you have a job.

Have a large screen TV? I'm talking about full HD LCD or plasma models. If you do, you'll see that TV broadcasts all over India (even in DTH services) are broadcast only in 720p (excepting some HD broadcasts on Reliance BIG TV and Sun Direct). What a waste! And so, with only Blu-ray delivering true HD content, it looks like all those 1080p pixels are going to waste.

But wait! What if you replace your Blu-ray player with a computer and a HDTV tuner card? Suddenly, things become interesting. Imagine all the things that you can do with it. Play games at very high resolutions! Watch

TV and Blu-rays! Listen to MP3s, watch all those XviD movies, see pictures on the TV instead of on the computer or the crammed LCD of the camera, get weather info, synopses of the movie that you are watching, IMDB ratings, cover art...

It looks like this dream is set to become a reality!

The hardware

I presume you already have a HDTV that can connect via HDMI. It would also be an added bonus if you have a 7.1 or at least a 5.1 speaker system.

Okay! Time to list out some hardware: